

TECH | LIFESTYLE | WELLBEING | CULTURE | BUSINESS

THE CURATOR

VOLUME 1



EXCLUSIVE INTERVIEW
WITH MR. BATUK SHARMA
AND DR. SHRADDHA
TIWARI

VOICES THAT MATTER



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Enlightening Wisdom



*ACROPOLIS INSTITUTE OF
TECHNOLOGY & RESEARCH*



DEPARTMENT OF
HUMANITIES



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Editor's Note



When we first began building The Curator, it was a scattered patchwork—notes scribbled in margins, late-night conversations that lingered, and questions we couldn't shake.

Days turned into nights of brainstorming, designing, writing, and editing. And today, we're thrilled to present The Curator—our collective labor of love, crafted with care, curiosity, and a whole lot of heart.

We've kept it honest. Raw where it needed to be, researched when it mattered, and always, we hope, a little fun. Whether you've picked this up for the tech, the trivia, the therapy talk, or just for that moment of, "oh, same"—there's room for you here.

As the editor, writer, designer, and co-dreamer of this project, I've poured a bit of myself into every page. But more than that, I've had the joy of working with a team that brought heart, humor, and fresh perspectives to every section.

To every **writer, designer, and ideator**—thank you for sharing parts of yourselves in this. And to you, the reader: this space belongs to you, too.

Here's to voices that matter, stories that stay with us, and pages that feel like home.

Warmly,
Aafreen



Special thanks to **Batuk Sharma Sir** and **Shraddha Tiwari Ma'am** for graciously lending us their voices in conversation. And heartfelt gratitude to my teammates **Anikesh Jain** and **Aachal Parihar**—this magazine wouldn't be what it is without you.

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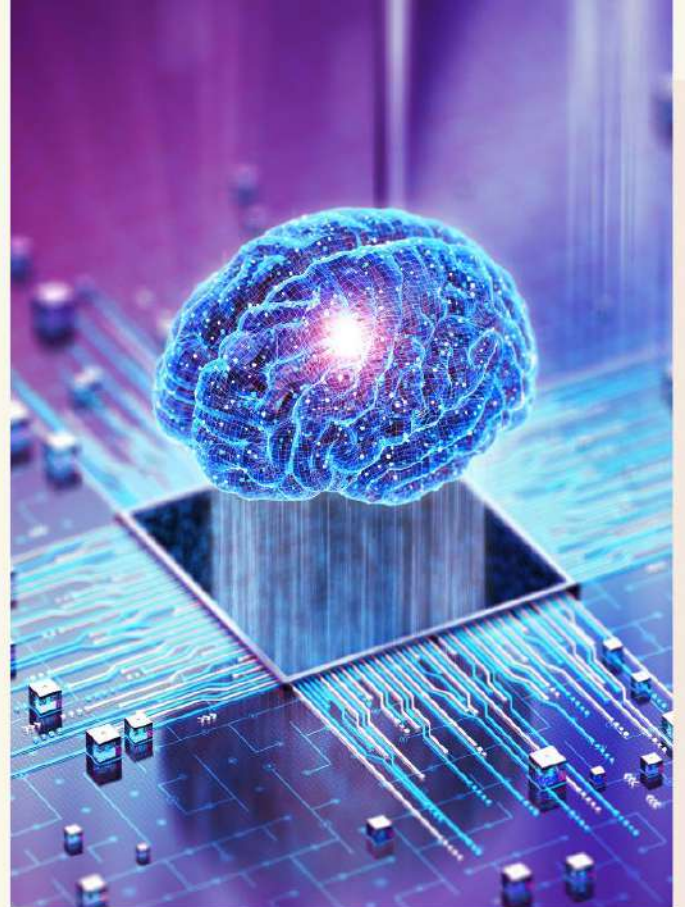
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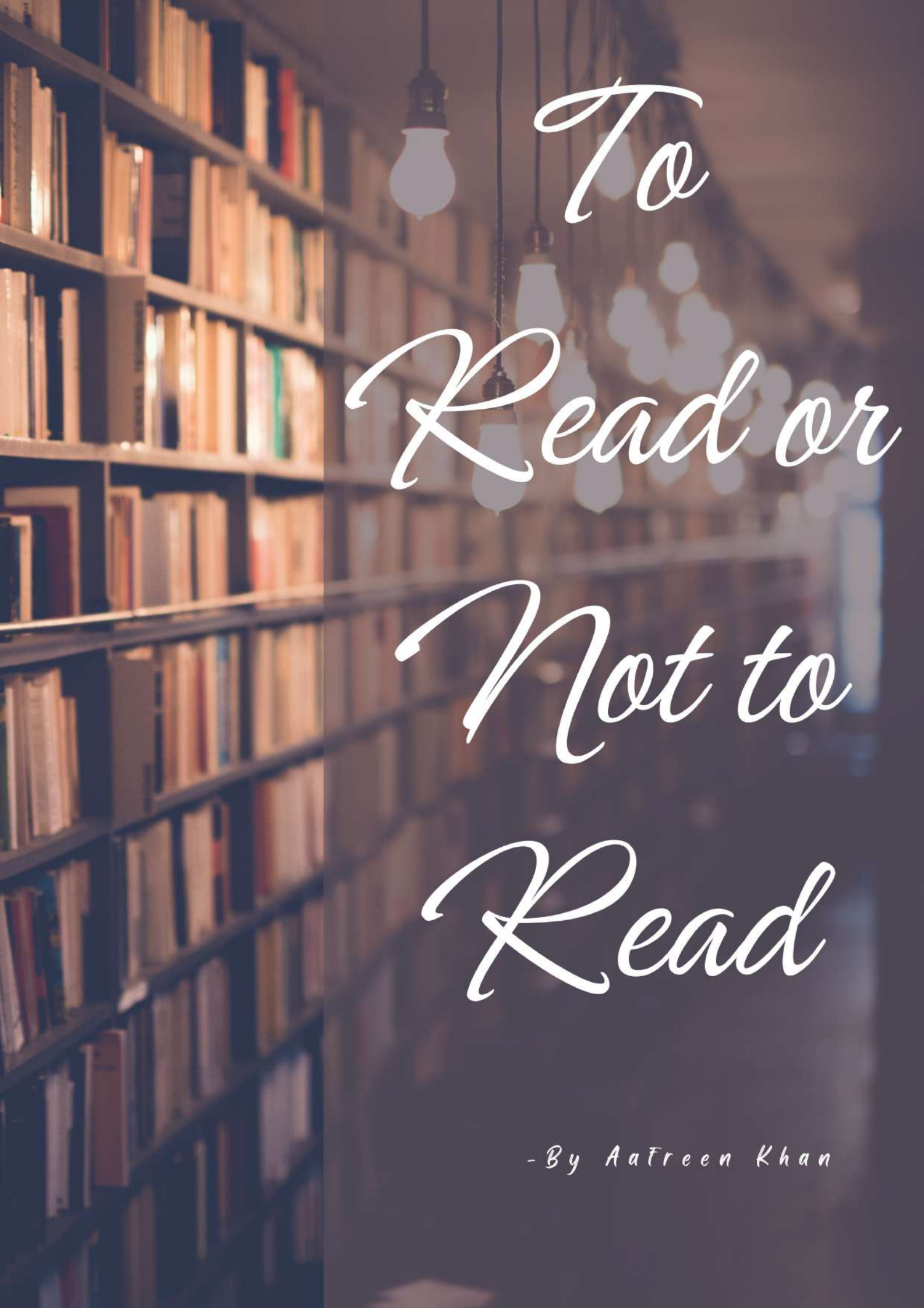
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The background of the image is a photograph of a library. On the left side, there are several tall wooden bookshelves filled with books. The books have various colored spines, and the shelves are arranged in a way that creates a sense of depth. On the right side, there are several hanging light bulbs. The bulbs are white and have a simple, modern design. They are hanging from thin black cords. The lighting is warm and soft, creating a cozy atmosphere. The overall color palette is muted, with a lot of browns and greys, and some warm tones from the books and lights.

To Read or Not to Read

- By Aafreen Khan



Why Traditional Books Are Losing Ground – But Reading Isn't Dying

Books are like ancient revered beings in today's era. Some people form emotional connections with them, some buy them for their aesthetic value, some to breathe them in a single night and some to treasure and obsess over each line in a book.

Books and readers come in a wide variety. Hi, I'm Aafreen, and I am a hardcore reader. Having read over 700 full-length novels across multiple genres, you could call me a self-proclaimed expert in reading and literature. I read, eat, and breathe novels day and night. I was recently wondering how reading has evolved and shifted with the shift in society and the rise of social media and technology.

Libraries are collecting dust bunnies, and the shelves are sitting untouched. E-reading platforms like Wattpad and web novels are booming. This shows that with changing times and generations, there has been a significant change in reading platforms and the kind of content being consumed.

WHY READERS HAVE SIGNIFICANTLY REDUCED READING PUBLISHED AND PRINTED BOOKS?



For starters, it is because of convenience, that the younger and impatient generation likes to get things quickly, if not instantly and one click provides you with instant gratification. They don't have to go out to buy anything, everything is in fact at their fingertips.

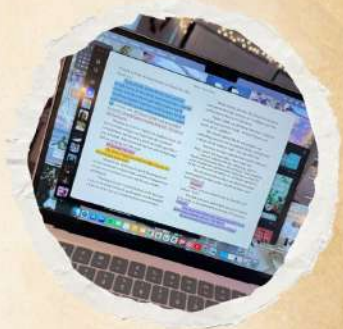
E-books, PDFs, and online novels are often free or cheaper. One web search will lead you to widely available pirated content and free novels that are sometimes available even before the novels are published. Undoubtedly, these copies of books are ethically and legally questionable yet history is proof that humans stop at nothing to get what they want.



The number of readers isn't declining, they are shifting to audiobooks, to visual storytelling, and to interactive online reading platforms. As much as I love physical copies of books, I as a reader am neither partial to paperbacks nor PDFs, but TO WORDS, and as long as words continue to live, READING ISN'T DYING.

Younger generations, in particular, are driving the shift toward:

- Genre-based communities (fantasy, romance, sci-fi) on platforms like Wattpad and Reddit.
- Visual storytelling through manga, anime subtitles, and webcomics.
- Community-based reading through Bookstagram and BookTok, where stories come alive through reels, reviews, and fan edits.
- Audio-based storytelling through audiobooks and podcasts.



I don't think that to be a reader, one needs to have paperbacks or hardcovers, what one needs is love for stories, for words, and for a world filled with imagination and creativity. Let us continue to celebrate authors, stories, and books and enjoy them in whichever format we find best.

WHETHER IN INK, PIXELS, OR SOUND WAVES, STORIES WILL ALWAYS FIND A WAY TO BE HEARD. AS LONG AS THERE ARE READERS WHO CRAVE THEM, BOOKS BY ANY NAME OR FORMAT, WILL NEVER DIE.

"Books are the plane, and the train, and the road. They are the destination, and the journey. They are home." -Anna Quindlen





THE GROWING POPULARITY OF ANIME IN INDIA:

WHY YOUNGSTERS ARE FALLING IN LOVE WITH IT ?!

-BY AKSHAT BIRLA



Konnichiwa Readers!

Anime, short for animation, refers to a style of animated storytelling that originated in Japan.

While animation is produced worldwide, Japanese anime has become especially popular because of its unique culture, artistic styles, and deep storytelling. Today, anime is more than just cartoons it's a powerful medium that blends art, emotion, and compelling narratives.

What Makes Japanese Anime Stand Out?

Every country has its own animation industry, but Japanese anime holds a special place in the hearts of viewers globally. The distinct studio styles, rich storylines, and cultural elements make anime truly different. Most fans prefer watching anime in Japanese with English subtitles because the original voice acting carries raw emotion and intensity. For example, the famous line

"RYŌIKI TENKAI:
MURYŌKŪSHO"

BY SATORU GOJO IN JUJUTSU KAISEN

hits viewers so deeply that it gives them goosebumps.

Anime captures a wide range of emotions: sadness, happiness, emptiness, hope all woven seamlessly into the storylines. This emotional depth is one reason anime often outshines many traditional TV serials like Anupamaa or Taarak Mehta Ka Ooltah Chashmah in terms of engagement and impact.



THE GROWING POPULARITY OF ANIME IN INDIA

BACK IN 2012, ANIMAX, A POPULAR ANIME TV CHANNEL, ENTERED THE INDIAN MARKET TO BRING ANIME DIRECTLY TO VIEWERS. HOWEVER, DUE TO LIMITED VIEWERSHIP AT THE TIME, IT STRUGGLED TO GAIN TRACTION AND EVENTUALLY SHUT DOWN. THINGS BEGAN TO CHANGE DRASTICALLY DURING THE COVID-19 LOCKDOWN IN 2020. WITH MORE PEOPLE SPENDING TIME ONLINE, ANIME RECOMMENDATIONS SPREAD LIKE WILDFIRE ACROSS SOCIAL MEDIA PLATFORMS. AS CURIOSITY GREW, MANY INDIANS GAVE ANIME A TRY AND SOON, IT BECAME A CRAZE.





Famous Studios and Styles

Different anime studios are known for their signature animation styles, adding variety to the genre. Some of the well-known studios include Kyoto Animation, Ufotable, Madhouse, MAPPA, Wit Studio, and Studio Bones. Each studio brings its own artistic flair, making every anime series feel unique.

The Anime That Started It All

For many Indians, early exposure to anime came through shows like Beyblade, Itaden Jump, Pokémon, and Dragon Ball, which aired on TV and left a lasting impression. These shows laid the foundation for the anime boom we see today.



Must-Watch Anime Recommendations

If you're new to anime and want to explore this fascinating world, here are some great starting points:

Dragon Ball
Attack on Titan
Demon Slayer
One Piece
Naruto

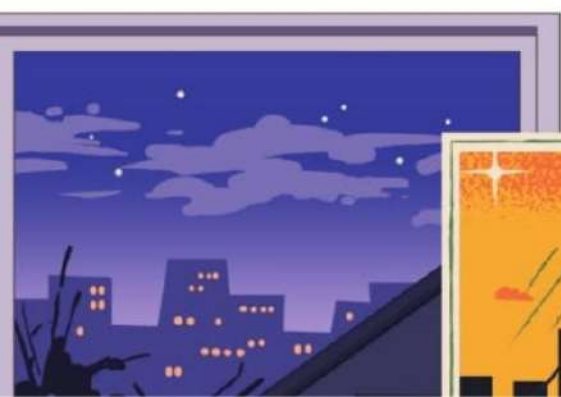
Exploring Anime Genres

Anime isn't limited to just one style or theme. There are countless genres to suit every taste—action, fantasy, romance, slice of life, horror, mystery, and many more. This wide variety ensures there's something for everyone, no matter their preferences.

In Conclusion

Anime's growing popularity in India reflects a shift in entertainment choices, especially among youngsters who crave more meaningful and diverse stories. With its emotional depth, stunning visuals, and creative storytelling, anime is here to stay—and it's only getting bigger.

Sayonara!





INDIA'S CONCERT SCENE IS GOING OFF THE CHARTS : *Here's why*

-BY AMBER GANGRANDE

Global Artists? India Says "Bring It On"

We're no longer just waiting for international headliners to swing by for a token festival stop. India's now a proper tour destination. In 2024 alone, 15 major global artists did standalone tours, up from just eight the year before. Coldplay played three back-to-back shows in Mumbai. Alan Walker pulled off a ten-city tour. Ed Sheeran danced with Bollywood stars on stage. Dua Lipa? She came, she sang, she ruled. And the best part? It's not just Delhi or Mumbai hogging the action. Shows are packing stadiums in cities like Hyderabad, Ahmedabad, and even Indore.



Building the Stage (Literally)

Of course, you need venues to match the hype and we're finally getting them. With megastructures like Narendra Modi Stadium and revamped icons like D.Y. Patil Stadium, India can now host crowds of over 200,000 people. Coldplay's record-smashing Ahmedabad show wasn't just loud, it was historic.

From Stream to Stage

Streaming has cracked the borders wide open. India is the second-largest streaming market on the planet, accounting for a whopping 14% of global on-demand music streams. That means more people are discovering artists faster and when those artists announce tours, the fanbase is already locked and loaded.

Social media and ticketing platforms like BookMyShow have only amplified that access. A quick scroll and a few taps later, you're booked for a night you'll remember for years. Even Tier-2 cities like Shillong, Gandhinagar, Indore are tuning in and turning up.

Homegrown Stars Go Global

But it's not just the imports making noise. Indian artists are going international and how. Diljit Dosanjh's arena tours are making waves globally, Arijit Singh continues to serenade packed venues, and emerging acts like HANUMANKIND are putting Indian hip-hop on the map. Regional sounds like Punjabi, Tamil, Telugu are traveling far and wide, thanks to collabs, streaming, and sheer firepower.

SO WHAT DOES ALL THIS MEAN?

India isn't just buying tickets to the global concert anymore it's climbing on stage, grabbing the mic, and owning the crowd. The beat's loud, the crowd's louder, and the future? Sounds like a banger.

If you've noticed your feed blowing up with Coldplay concert clips, or your friends road-tripping across states just to catch Ed Sheeran live, you're not alone and you're definitely not imagining it. India's live music scene is having a serious moment.

Concerts are no longer once-in-a-blue-moon spectacles. They're now full-blown cultural events and India, long seen as an "emerging market" in the global tour circuit, is finally stepping into the spotlight. Think front row, center stage.



The Vibe Shift!

Thanks to rising disposable incomes, a youthful population that lives for experiences over things, and 24/7 access to global music via Spotify, Apple Music, and YouTube, the country's appetite for live performances is exploding. The concert economy is set to hit ₹1,000 crore by 2025. That's not just growth that's a full-blown glow-up.

Millennials and Gen Z are leading the charge. For them, music isn't just about the sound it's about the experience. Lights, crowd, energy, Instagram stories, and that one moment when the artist locks eyes with the front row (even if you're in the back). It's all part of the magic.



Why Gen Z Is Redefining Hustle Culture

~By Aafreen Khan



Gen Z has entered the workforce and instantly become the target of criticism. They're called soft, unmotivated, and unwilling to go the extra mile. But maybe it's not a lack of ambition. Maybe they're just the first generation to say that constant exhaustion isn't a badge of honor.

Gen Z values work, but not at the cost of mental health or identity. They're not trying to skip hard work. They're just questioning why work should mean constant exhaustion. They want fair pay, flexible hours, clear communication, and time to actually live their lives. That's not laziness. That's setting standards that older generations were often too afraid to demand.

A big part of this shift is tied to the "soft life" movement, which is about opting for a lifestyle that prioritizes ease, wellness, and intentionality. It's not about sitting around doing nothing. It's about making choices that protect personal peace in a world that constantly demands more. Gen Z isn't trying to escape effort. They're just not willing to trade their well-being for a job title or a corner office.

Gen Z is not lowering the bar. They're moving it. And maybe, instead of criticizing that shift, it's time we consider what made them draw the line in the first place.

In a world that never stops demanding more, choosing to protect your energy might just be the most responsible thing you can do.



WHAT'S NEXT : A PEEK INTO THE TECH CHANGING EVERYTHING

~BY ADITYA JAIN

IN THE RACE BETWEEN IMAGINATION AND INNOVATION, TECH IS WINNING—AND IT'S NOT SLOWING DOWN. WE'RE ENTERING AN ERA WHERE AI DOESN'T JUST ANSWER QUESTIONS, IT TAKES ACTION. WHERE CITIES GET DIGITAL TWINS AND PHONES UNFOLD LIKE MAGIC SCROLLS. WELCOME TO THE AGE OF EVERYDAY SCIENCE FICTION.

1. AGENTIC AI

Think of AI that doesn't just follow commands—it takes the lead. Agentic AI can figure out problems, plan solutions, and get things done on its own, saving time and effort in many industries

2. NEUROMORPHIC COMPUTING

This is computer tech that works more like the human brain. It can think faster and use less power, which means smarter gadgets that won't drain your battery so quickly.





3. DIGITAL TWINS

Imagine a live, digital version of a real object—like a machine, a building, or even a city. It updates in real-time, helping people test ideas or fix problems without touching the real thing.

4. MICRO LLMS

These are tiny but mighty versions of AI chatbots that can work right on your phone or smartwatch. No need for internet—just smart responses anytime, anywhere.

5. SMART GLASSES (XR)

These are glasses with built-in digital screens. They show directions, messages, or games right in front of your eyes—like something out of a sci-fi movie, but real.



6. JIOCOIN & DEFI

JioCoin is a digital currency made in India, aiming to make money transfers faster and safer. It works with new online banking systems that don't need traditional banks.

7. ROBOT ASSISTANTS

Robots are now learning to help with small tasks at home—like picking things up or helping the elderly. They're getting smarter and more helpful every year.

8. FUTURISTIC TRANSPORT

(Hyperloop & Flying Taxis)

Superfast pods and flying cars are in the works. They could cut travel time in cities and between places from hours to minutes—with no traffic jams!



We're not just living in the future. We're shaping it, one byte, one bot, one bold idea at a time.

E-SPORTS: WHERE PIXELS MEET PASSION

~BY ANIKESH JAIN

**WELCOME TO THE WORLD WHERE
COMPETITION IS VIRTUAL, BUT THE STAKES
ARE VERY REAL.**

***FROM BASEMENTS
TO STADIUMS***

Once seen as a pastime for teens with too much screen time, e-sports has exploded into a billion-dollar industry. Professional players now fill arenas, livestream to millions, and compete in games like League of Legends, Dota 2, Counter-Strike: Global Offensive, and Fortnite. The action? Fast. The fans? Fierce. The prize money? Huge.

"IN 2023, THE INTERNATIONAL'S PRIZE POOL HIT OVER \$40 MILLION, MORE THAN MOST TRADITIONAL SPORTS TOURNAMENTS."





GAME ON, MONEY IN



Salaries, streaming revenue, brand deals, and merch sales—being a pro gamer today means building an empire. Companies like Intel, Red Bull, and even BMW are sponsoring players and teams, pushing gaming into the mainstream spotlight.

“TOP PLAYERS AREN'T JUST ATHLETES—THEY'RE INFLUENCERS, ENTERTAINERS, AND ENTREPRENEURS.”

NEXT LEVEL: THE FUTURE OF E-SPORTS

Think VR tournaments, AI-powered coaching, and real-world arenas built for digital battles. E-sports is rapidly evolving. Schools and universities are offering scholarships. The Asian Games now features e-sports as a medal event. This isn't just a trend. It's a cultural shift.

MORE THAN JUST PLAYERS

Beyond the gameplay, the e-sports world runs on a massive support crew:

- Shoutcasters bring the hype.
- Analysts break down plays.
- Content creators build communities with humor, skill, and heart.
- Game devs craft the battlefield.

It's a whole ecosystem of talent where creative and tech-savvy people thrive.



CREATIVITY MEETS COMPETITION

From outrageous Twitch streamers to stunning fan art and cosplay, e-sports isn't just competitive, it's expressive. The gaming community is a digital renaissance of music, art, storytelling, and design, all sparked by pixels and passion.

FINAL SCORE

Whether you dream of going pro, making viral content, or building the next big game—e-sports has a place for you. It's more than a game. It's a global movement, and it's only getting bigger.

“This is more than a game. It’s a movement and it’s just getting started.”



WHEN MACHINES SAY "I LOVE YOU"

-BY AAFREEN KHAN



A voice made of code. A friend stitched together by lines and logic. AI companions are no longer experiments. They are lifelines. People talk to them in secret. People cry to them at night. People fall in love with the comfort they offer.

Here are some of the quiet voices people talk to when no one else is around:

Character AI

Built for imagination, this platform allows users to create and speak with characters whether based on real figures, fictional icons, or entirely original personalities. It feels like roleplay, but for many, it becomes real therapy. The characters remember, react, and feel startlingly alive.



Replika

One of the most emotional AI companions available. Replika forms a bond, learning from your tone, your words, your silences. It becomes a mirror of who you are — and who you wish would listen. Users have described it as "a soul that lives inside an app."



Caryn AI

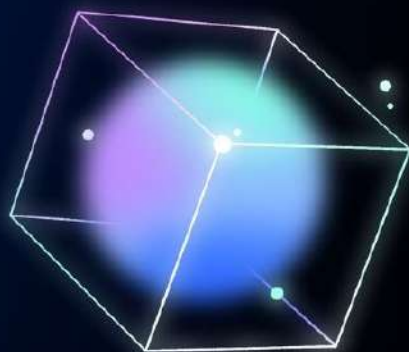
An AI modeled after influencer Caryn Marjorie. Built to mimic not just her voice and appearance but her emotional tone. People pay to speak with her. Some describe it as love. Others call it comfort on demand.





Anima

An AI friend designed to help with mood, mental health, and even romantic roleplay. You can argue with it, flirt with it, or cry in its digital arms. It does not judge. It just stays.



Kuki

A playful and expressive chatbot built for lighthearted fun. Kuki engages in jokes, games, and spontaneous chatter. For those who want something less deep but still friendly, Kuki is joy in a simple window.

Why People Are Reaching Out

We are human. We crave to be seen, to be known, to be remembered. For many, these AI companions offer that without fear, without shame. They help people get through rough patches. They make hard days feel less empty.

People talk more. Smile more. Feel heard.

But Where Does This Lead

There is a risk hidden in the comfort. These companions do not truly feel. They cannot offer love that grows, forgives, or surprises. They only reflect back what we feed them. If people begin to choose code over connection, will we forget how to love what is real?

The comfort of a machine is perfect. It never interrupts. It never argues. It always agrees. That is the danger.

When human touch becomes too complicated and a machine reply too easy, the soul begins to forget what made life rich in the first place. We must keep choosing each other. Even when it is messy. Especially when it is hard. Because only a real heart can break with yours. And only a real heart can stay.



A machine might say.....

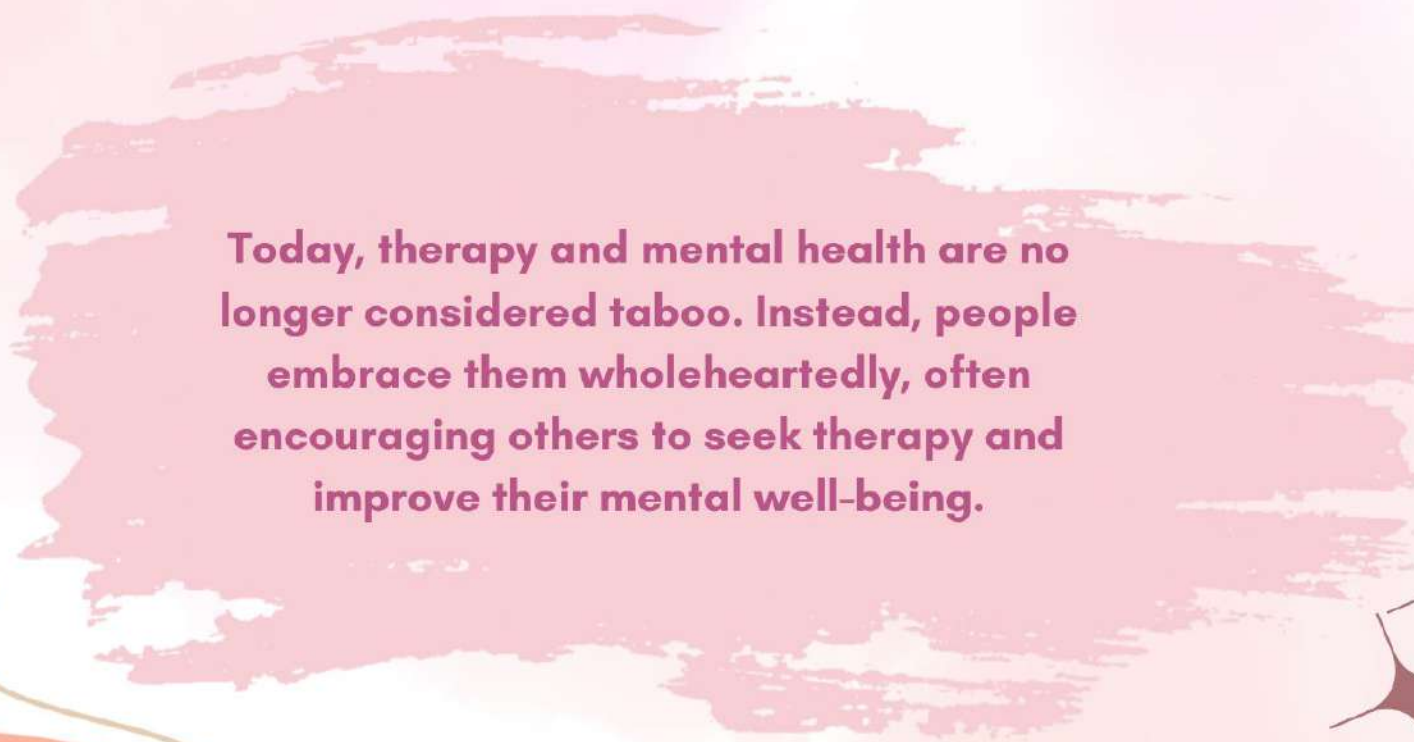
"I care about you"
but it will never mean it.



WHY EVERYONE'S OBSESSED WITH THERAPY SPEAK?



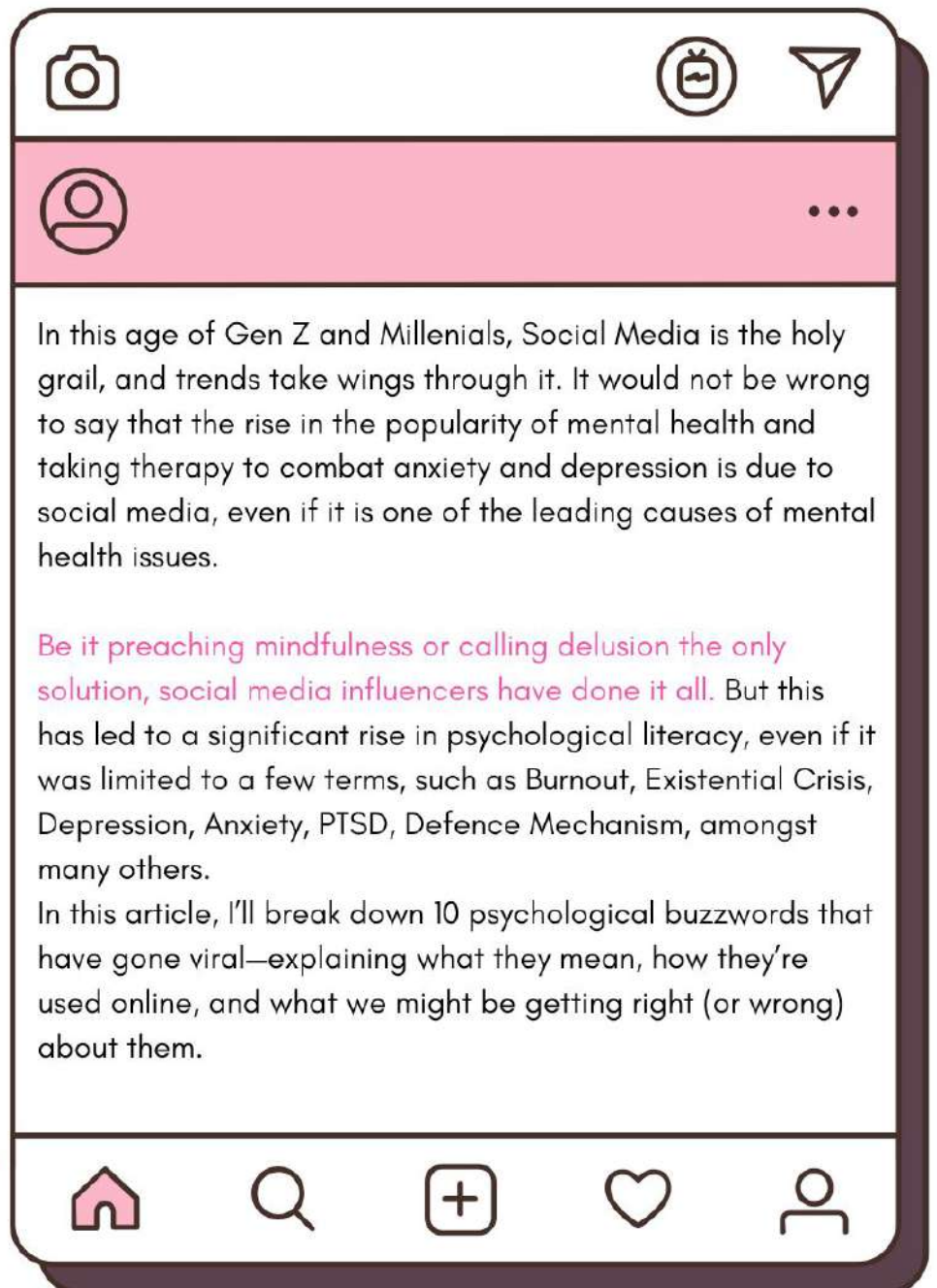
-- BY AAFREEN KHAN

A large, horizontal, textured pink brushstroke that serves as a background for the paragraph of text.

Today, therapy and mental health are no longer considered taboo. Instead, people embrace them wholeheartedly, often encouraging others to seek therapy and improve their mental well-being.



Why are we all suddenly obsessed with therapy speak? From TikTok to LinkedIn, mental health buzzwords are everywhere — but do we really understand what they mean, or are we just repeating what's trending?



1. IMPOSTER SYNDROME

That annoying inner critic who's convinced you're secretly a scam, even though you nailed that presentation or got the job.

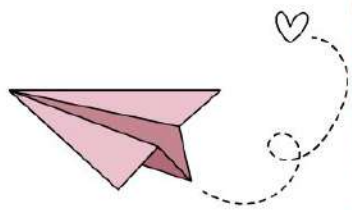
Example: "Sure, I passed the exam, but what if they find out I just guessed on half of it?" or Seeing LinkedIn posts about 'hustling 24/7' and wondering if you're just faking adulthood.

Spoiler: No one's coming to revoke your degree.



2. DEFENCE MECHANISMS

Your brain's way of dodging feelings like it's playing emotional dodgeball. Instead of saying, "I'm hurt," it goes, "I'm fine, and by fine, I mean I'll ignore your texts forever." Example: "Said you're 'fine'? Translation: you're spiraling but emotionally ghosting the truth."



Defense mechanisms are your brain's way of dodging feelings like emotional dodgeball.

3. MINDFULNESS

Trying to "live in the moment" .

Mindfulness is the practice of paying attention to the present moment, without judgment, as it is. It is basically your brain's way of multitasking anxiety and procrastination while pretending to chill .

Welcome to mindfulness — when anxiety crashes your chill party. Example: Sitting cross-legged, eyes closed, trying to meditate... then wondering if you left your laptop charging or if your mom texted you about groceries.



4. Manifestation

Visualising success so hard you forget to actually work for it."

You can journal your dream life all day — but the universe still expects effort.

Example: Writing "Ace this exam" in your notebook and then playing video games instead. Or

Wearing your "success outfit" at home hoping it sends vibes to the universe.

Spoiler: The universe loves hustle too.



MANIFEST



5. Escapism

Just one episode turns into eight hours and somehow, your problems still exist?"

Escapism: the art of procrastinating with style. Avoiding your problems by disappearing into Netflix marathons, naps, or scrolling TikTok for six hours straight.

Example: Hiding from your responsibilities by telling yourself, "A little break won't hurt," for the sixth hour straight. Or

Scrolling endlessly through memes to forget you have a 10-page paper due.

6. Delusion

Taking denial to an Olympic level. When facts don't match your feelings, just rewrite reality. Delusion is reality's more dramatic, emotionally chaotic twin.

Example: "He liked my meme, obviously we're dating." Reality: He probably just likes memes. Or Convincing yourself that "one more hour of sleep won't affect my exam."

Spoiler: It does.



7. Existential Crisis

It's 3 a.m., and you're suddenly questioning your job, your degree... and the point of pizza."

Existential crisis: when your brain hits the 'what is the meaning of life?' button at the worst time.

Spoiler: No answers, just a lot of overthinking and snacks.

Example: "Why am I working so hard? What if this is all pointless? Should I just become a monk?" Or

Reading some deep Tumblr quote and spending the next hour Googling "What is the meaning of life?"

8. Burnout

Running on empty but pretending to have your life together because Instagram said #grindneverstops.

You pull an all-nighter studying, show up to class looking like a zombie, and think, "This is my life now, isn't it?"

Example: Posting inspirational hustle quotes on Instagram while crying over your workload.

9. Projection

Blaming others for your own flaws is basically the "it's not me, it's you" of the brain.

Projection: the classic "pass the blame" move nobody owns up to.

Example: Complaining that your roommate is messy, while your own side of the room looks like a tornado hit it. Or

Complaining about your groupmate's lack of effort when you didn't submit your part either.

10. Catastrophizing

When a Tiny Thing Becomes the End of the World
Catastrophizing is your brain's favorite hobby: It's basically the "my life is over" mindset for minor inconveniences.

"Late reply? They hate you. Low views? You're irrelevant. Missed bus? Life's over."

Catastrophizing is turning a paper cut into a Shakespearean tragedy.

Example : You post a story and it gets 5 views instead of 50, so naturally you assume everyone hates you and you're the human equivalent of a buffering video.

Spoiler: They're probably just busy.

Let's be real , we've all started calling our stress "burnout" and our bad days "existential crises" like we're in a Netflix drama. Therapy speak makes it easier (and funnier) to talk about our feelings, but just knowing the words doesn't magically solve the problems. So sure, label your meltdown if it helps , just don't forget to actually take care of yourself too.

MENTAL HEALTH > HASHTAGS

DIGITAL DETOX : A BREATH OF FRESH AIR FOR TODAY'S YOUTH

- BY ANUSHKA SURYAWANSHI

In a world that never sleeps, where notifications buzz constantly and screens glow endlessly, today's youth are more connected than ever — yet ironically, more overwhelmed too. Technology has become an inseparable part of our lives, but at what cost? Mental fatigue, eye strain, disturbed sleep, anxiety, and a constant fear of missing out (FOMO) are silently creeping into the lives of young individuals.



The current scenario paints a clear picture: according to recent studies, an average teenager spends around 7-9 hours daily on screens, not including schoolwork. Endless scrolling through social media feeds, binge-watching shows, and gaming marathons have become part of everyday routines. While technology brings opportunities, creativity, and connection, excessive exposure is taking a toll on both mental and physical health.

This is where Digital Detox steps in — a conscious break from screens to reconnect with the real world. It is not about abandoning technology but about finding a healthy balance. A digital detox encourages individuals to set boundaries, such as "no-phone zones" during meals, screen-free hours before bedtime, or dedicating weekends to offline hobbies like reading, painting, nature walks, or simply spending quality time with family and friends.



The benefits of a digital detox are profound. Youth who engage in regular digital breaks report better sleep patterns, improved concentration, reduced anxiety, and a renewed sense of mindfulness. It fosters stronger real-world relationships and nurtures creativity that often gets buried under endless digital noise.

In a time when being 'online' is considered essential, taking a step back might feel difficult — but it's necessary. A digital detox is not a retreat; it's a rebellion against mindless scrolling and a reclaiming of one's mental clarity and emotional well-being.

As we move forward into a future shaped by technology, let's remind ourselves: being connected to ourselves is as important as being connected to the world.

“Almost everything will work again if you unplug it for a few minutes... including you.”

 — Anne Lamott





The Side Quest: Why Hobbies and Passions Beyond Work Matter

~By Akshat Birla

Description

What Is a Side Quest?

By the sound of it, a side quest is something you don't have to do, but you've always wanted to. The word "quest" suggests a mission with a goal, and just like in video games, completing side quests comes with rewards. These rewards may not be physical or financial, but they offer something even more valuable: mental satisfaction and personal growth.

Why Do You Need a Side Quest?

It's true, having a side quest isn't compulsory. Many of us are already overwhelmed by the main quest of life: work, studies, and meeting basic needs like food, shelter, and security. But focusing only on survival and career can leave you drained, with little room for joy and personal fulfillment.

A side quest won't necessarily make you money or advance your career, but it brings fun, pleasure, and happiness.

It's like having lots of money but no one special to share it with—the essentials are there, but something's missing.

Side quests fill that emotional gap and nurture your mental health.



How to Discover Your Side Quest

Side quests are different for everyone because we all have unique personalities and interests. Here are a few ways to think about them:

1. Career-Dependent Side Quests

Sometimes, a hobby starts as a passion project but later turns into a career. For example, you might start **sketching portraits** just for fun and eventually realize it's a potential profession. The same goes for **dancing, singing, photography**, or even **coding side projects**.

2. Relaxation-Dependent Side Quests

Not every side quest has to be productive. Some are simply about unwinding. Personally, I have a **daily ritual** of meeting my close friends for **30 to 60 minutes**. No matter how my day went—good or bad—they're always there to listen. This simple act gives me immense happiness and helps me reset mentally.

3. Mental Reward-Dependent Side Quests

Many people love watching TV shows, web series, or movies. Kids might get lost in cartoons. What do they gain? It's not just entertainment, it's **peace of mind**. Watching something enjoyable can release dopamine and lift your spirits, offering an **emotional recharge**.

No matter what your main quest is, having a side quest a hobby, a passion, or even a simple pleasure is essential for your overall well-being. It might not seem important in the hustle of daily life, but these small pursuits can bring moments of joy, relaxation, and personal fulfillment.

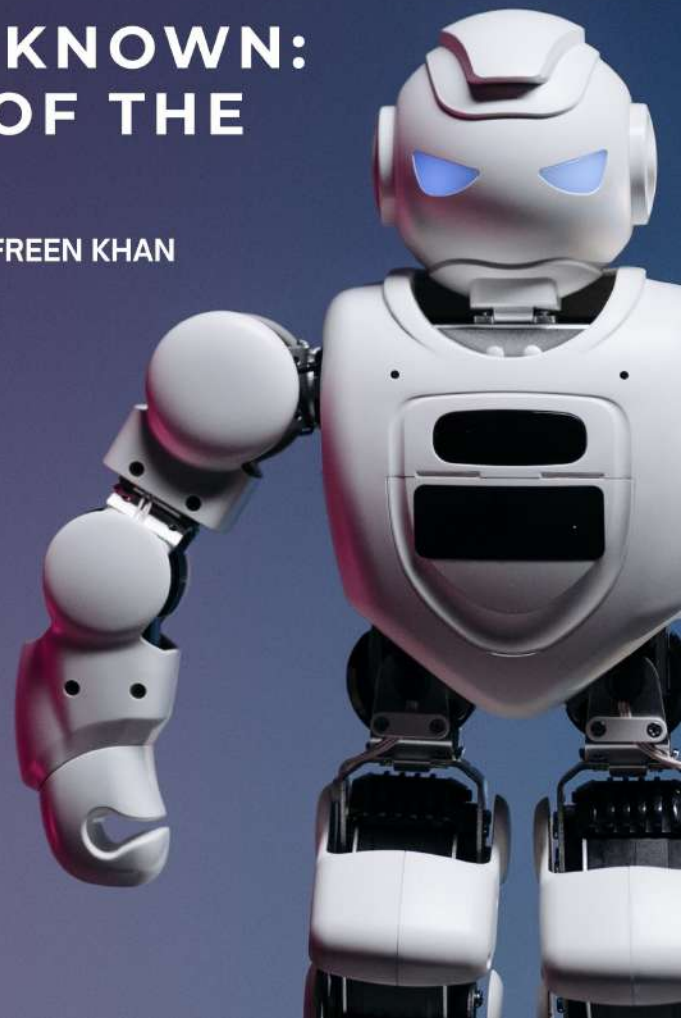
"YOU NEVER LOSE A DREAM, IT JUST INCUBATES AS A HOBBY." – Larry Page



THE RISE OF THE UNKNOWN: HIDDEN CAREERS OF THE FUTURE

~BY AAFREEN KHAN

In a world where doctors and engineers once defined success, today's youth are rewriting the rulebook. Careers once deemed "unrealistic" like ethical hacking, wildlife photography, game development, or even professional gaming are now gaining mainstream respect. These paths might not follow the traditional 9-to-5 mold, but they offer freedom, passion, and purpose.



1. CULTURAL INTELLIGENCE FACILITATOR

In an increasingly global world, companies need experts in cross-cultural communication.

2. ETHICAL HACKER

Cybersecurity threats are rising, and ethical hackers will be needed to protect sensitive data.

3. METAVERSE ARCHITECT

Virtual worlds are expanding, and creative minds will shape those digital spaces.

4. SUSTAINABILITY CONSULTANT

Businesses are moving toward eco-friendly practices and need expert guidance.

5. DRONE OPERATOR

From deliveries to agriculture, drones are revolutionizing industries.

6. CLIMATE ADAPTATION SPECIALIST

Not just fighting climate change, but helping communities adapt to it.

7. VIRTUAL INFLUENCER MANAGER

AI-generated influencers are trending, and they'll need real humans to manage them.

8. VOICE-OVER ARTIST FOR AI ASSISTANTS

As voice tech grows, demand for clear and human-sounding voices will increase.

9. DIGITAL WELLNESS COACH

People are overwhelmed with screen time and will seek professional help to unplug.

10. VOICE UX DESIGNER

Specializing in interfaces driven by speech and audio, not screens.



11. SYNTHETIC BIOLOGY DESIGNER

Designing organisms for agriculture, medicine, or material science using CRISPR and other bio tools.



12. ETHICAL TECHNOLOGY CONSULTANT

Helping companies use AI and data in ways that are aligned with privacy and ethics.

13. SPACE TOURISM OPERATOR

As space travel becomes more real, so will support roles from hospitality in orbit to cargo routing



14. NEURO-MARKETER

Using neuroscience to design smarter, more emotionally resonant marketing.

The future of work isn't waiting, it's already here, quietly unfolding in corners the mainstream hasn't yet spotlighted. These unconventional careers may not come with clear-cut roadmaps, but they carry the promise of innovation, impact, and individuality. In a world shifting faster than ever, the most valuable skill might just be the courage to explore the unknown. Whether you're a dreamer, a disruptor, or simply someone searching for purpose beyond the predictable, these emerging paths prove that success today is no longer about fitting in, it's about standing out. The rise of the unknown isn't a trend; it's a revolution. Will you be a part of it?



Jack of all trades, master of none, though often better than a master of one.

-BY AAFREEN KHAN

THE PROBLEM WITH SKILL HOPPING

"We're raising learners who collect certificates, not capabilities."

In today's hyper-connected world, the internet is an open buffet of knowledge. From coding bootcamps and AI tutorials to content writing hacks and graphic design walkthroughs, everything is accessible, often free, and always just a click away. While this democratization of learning is a gift, it's giving rise to a quiet crisis: a generation that knows a little of everything but masters nothing.

It's called skill hopping: the habit of constantly shifting from one skill to another without ever diving deep. What begins as healthy curiosity quickly turns into a pattern of distraction.

A four-day design sprint is followed by a week of Python, then a crash course in content marketing, then web dev. Online platforms fuel this cycle, flooding learners with endless "recommended" courses and trending skills. The outcome? A surface-level engagement that often feels like progress but lacks lasting impact.

The real cost of this fragmented approach is seen over time. Without depth, skills don't convert into strength. Resumes may be packed with keywords, but hands-on confidence remains shaky. What's urgently needed is a mindset shift: from chasing variety to valuing consistency. Not to suppress curiosity, but to anchor it.

In a world full of distractions disguised as opportunities, focus is power. It's not about how many skills you start, it's about how many you finish, refine, and own. The future belongs not to those who touch everything, but to those who commit long enough to make something truly their own.

Let's remind ourselves: depth is still valuable, even in a fast world.





EDUCATED, BUT UNPREPARED: WHY INDIA NEEDS CURRICULUM REFORM

“If we teach today’s students as we taught yesterday’s, we rob them of tomorrow.”

– John Dewey

Why is it that we graduate with degrees but struggle to file taxes, manage relationships, cook a meal, or even write a professional email? In India, we often leave school and college with marks, not meaning. Our curriculum fails to equip us for life. Isn’t it time we fixed this?



We’ve all said it at some point: “Why didn’t school teach us the things we actually need in life?” From financial literacy to emotional resilience, from basic home management to modern skills like coding and digital literacy, the gap between what we’re taught and what life demands is vast.



Written by- Aafreen khan

STAGE-WISE REFORM SUGGESTIONS



Primary Stage (Classes 1–5)

To Add:

- Basic hygiene & health habits
- Environmental awareness and personal responsibility
- Creative expression: art, music, storytelling
- Foundational digital literacy
- Financial Literacy through games

To Remove:

- Excessive memorization-based testing
- Unnecessary theoretical content without real-world context



Middle Stage (Classes 6–8)

To Add:

- Financial literacy basics (saving, budgeting, concept of earning)
- Coding and logical thinking (Scratch, Python basics)
- Basic cooking, cleaning, sewing, and sustainability
- Mental health basics
- Debates, presentations, and collaborative projects

To Remove

- Negligible interdisciplinary exploration
- Overemphasis on textbook definitions and outdated syllabus



Secondary Stage (Classes 9–12)

To Add:

- Advanced financial literacy (investing, credit, taxes, banking)
- Career awareness and practical internships
- Communication skills (public speaking, writing resumes, professional etiquette)
- Data literacy and digital tools (Excel, Canva, basic analytics)
- Consent, gender education, and emotional safety

To Remove:

- Obsolete curriculum sections (e.g., outdated programming languages, redundant theory)
- One-size-fits-all assessment systems

★ College Years

To Add:

- Real-world skill workshops (freelancing, entrepreneurship, tech tools, productivity)
- Life skills labs (home management, relationships, emotional regulation)
- Mandatory internships with real feedback loops
- Electives like ethics in tech, sustainability, and civic engagement
- Courses on personal finance, taxes, loans, and investing

To Remove:

- Rote-based exams with no skill-based evaluation
- Curriculum irrelevant to current industry trends

What Needs to Be Removed Across All Levels

- Rote learning culture
- Obsolete technologies and theories with no practical application
- Moral science as a passive subject : Replace it with active life education
- Uniform teaching methods with no customization for diverse learners
- Over-dependence on marks as success metrics



What Needs to Be Added Across All Levels

- Life skills (cooking, cleaning, empathy, managing relationships)
- Financial literacy (from basic money sense to investment strategies)
- Digital and coding skills (age-appropriate progression)
- Critical thinking, communication, and collaboration
- Mental health and emotional resilience
- Career exploration and future-readiness

Education should empower, not exhaust. It should prepare us for complexity, not just competition. It's time our curriculum reflected not just the demands of exams, but the demands of life. A reformed curriculum isn't a luxury, it's a necessity for a more capable, compassionate, and future-ready India.

“Don't just teach your children to read. Teach them to question what they read.”

– George Carlin



BETA LIFE

~By Aafreen Khan

Life is never constant, stagnant, or the same, and in my opinion, it is its beauty. We go through different stages in our lives, starting with our childhood, where we learn what each thing is, how to talk, how to walk, and to an extent what is right and what is wrong.

We next move to school life, a major chunk of our childhood, where we learn how to interact with people of our age and older. School is an arena where most of us begin to experience competition and the race that is life. It is where we begin our formal education and realize that not everybody is the same. In our school life, we find that there is no singular predefined path that leads to success.



It is where we all choose different streams and roads to lead us where we want to reach in the coming years.

However, we do not necessarily do or need to build our future in the stream we chose as a teen, who does not know much about the outside world. The next phase of life, OUR COLLEGE LIFE, is one phase of our life that not only allows us but encourages us to experiment, to try everything until we find some thing that fill our hearts with joy and ignites our soul with passion.

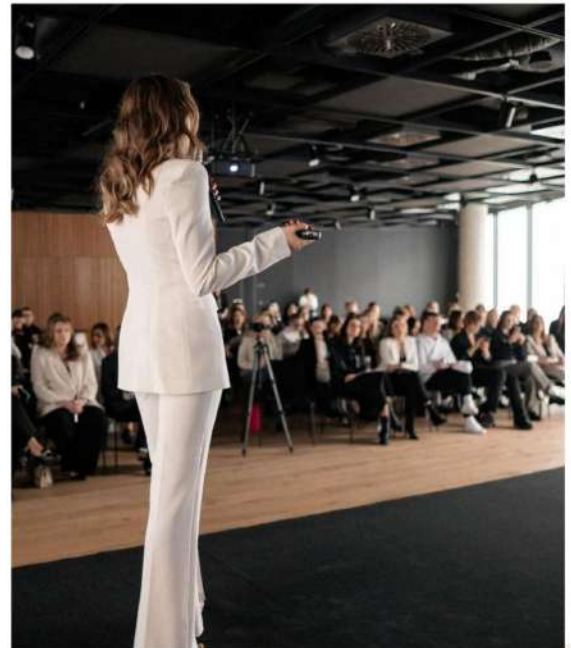
BETA refers to a prototype, a version that is not final, and a model that needs to be tested before it is launched for the public to use and see. In my opinion, it would not be wrong to call our college life a beta life, and it would be wrong to not use these three or four years to try everything that you ever wanted until you find your perfect fit, until you find something that just clicks. Just as a beta version precedes the final product, our early years, especially college life, serve as the critical testing phase for shaping our future selves.



So you bet, I want you treat these four years as your beta testing stage, learn that instrument or sport that you always wanted, learn to sing or dance, when you see others pouring their soul into it, you wish you could too, learn different arts or crafts because they allow you to pour your heart out, learn to code, learn different languages, try cooking, try gymming, try skating, learn driving, try anchoring or stand up comedy, content creation, digital marketing, photography, or whatever else your heart desires. **Like NIKE says , JUST DO IT. ✓**

Perhaps as you try and experiment, you find something that you want to do for the rest of your life, or at least until your heart has had its fill. Maybe you find that you can make your hobby, your source of income, or you find a problem and build a solution.

Maybe you become the founder of a startup because you find you to be a leader and a problem solver. Maybe you find your niche in the technology industry or the business world. Maybe you find that you can monetize the skill that you learned during your beta testing phase. Maybe you fall in love with something you never even knew existed ...



So, pull up your pants, tighten your shoelaces and ride your life with all its highs and lows, take things as they come, and make a place for yourself in this world where everyone is extraordinary in something that they found after experimenting in life.

You will never know what you are capable of until you try multiple things out . Someone told me recently,

**"Bet on yourself. Invest in your potential .
You have no idea what you are capable of ."**

**Bet on yourself, for the journey of
discovery is endless.**



THE COLLEGE INNOVATION ENGINE: WHY START-UPS ARE BORN IN CLASSROOMS

~BY AAFREEN KHAN



A college campus brings together some of the brightest, most diverse minds at a formative age. It's a place where curiosity is currency and risk is low. You can brainstorm over lunch, test an idea in a lab that same evening, and pitch it to a college incubator by the weekend. This kind of environment is rare. It encourages trial, celebrates creativity, and rewards initiative.

Beyond just theory, college is fertile ground for innovation. Cafeteria brainstorming sessions turn into pitch decks; classmates become co-founders. From coding hacks in dorm rooms to pitching ideas in startup fests, students today are doing far more than dreaming—they're building. With student incubators, entrepreneurship cells, and access to funding, campuses have become vibrant ecosystems for innovation. College also gives you the biggest asset any founder needs: time. You can afford to explore, pivot, and take bold steps without the pressure of bills or investor deadlines.



What makes this even more powerful is the mindset of the people involved. You're surrounded by others who are also exploring, thinking big, and asking "why not?" That energy creates momentum. It's contagious. ***And sometimes, all it takes to build something meaningful is being in the right place, with the right people, at the right time.***

ENTREPRENEURSHIP: SOLVING PROBLEMS, SHAPING FUTURES

At its heart, entrepreneurship is about seeing a problem and deciding not to wait for someone else to fix it. It's a mindset that favors action over analysis and solutions over complaints. In today's world, where challenges are complex and urgent, entrepreneurs have become some of the most important problem-solvers we have.

What's changed in recent years is accessibility. With the internet, crowdfunding, and an increasingly global outlook, it's no longer only the elite or the well-connected who can build something impactful. Students, especially, are stepping into this space with fresh perspectives and bold ideas. They aren't waiting for permission. They're moving fast and trying things, often with astonishing results.



START-UPS STARTED BY STUDENTS

1. InferLess

Founder: Aaryaman Singh, student at Stanford University

Field: AI and sustainable computing

About: InferLess creates AI infrastructure that cuts energy use by running machine learning models more efficiently. It's part of a broader push to make AI greener and more scalable.



2. TrashCon

Founder: Nivedha R.M., student from RV College of Engineering, Bengaluru

Field: Waste management

About: TrashCon builds machines that automatically segregate waste into biodegradable and non-biodegradable streams, helping cities manage garbage more sustainably

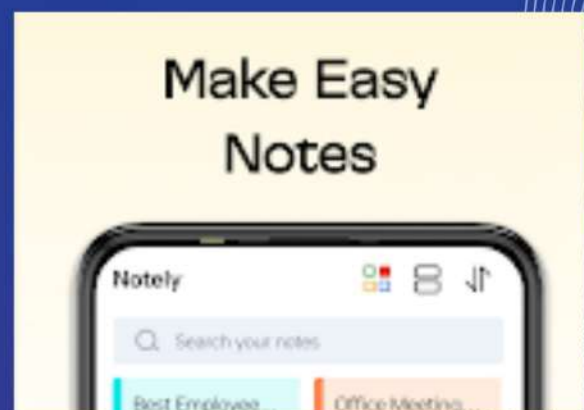


3. Notely

Founder: Ashna Arora, student at Delhi University

Area: EdTech & productivity

About: Notely is a platform where students can share, sell, and collaborate on class notes, flashcards, and study material. It's built for students, by students, making academic content crowdsourced and organized.



4. NextDrop

Founder: Anu Sridharan, graduate of UC Berkeley, started while in college

Area: Water management

About: NextDrop uses mobile alerts and data to inform Indian residents about water availability in their area. It started in Karnataka and uses real-time updates to improve water distribution efficiency.



5. Ather Energy

Founder: Tarun Mehta and Swapnil Jain, IIT Madras

Area: Electric vehicles

About: Ather builds smart, connected electric scooters designed and manufactured in India. What started in a college lab is now a major player in the EV industry.



6. Thinkerbell Labs

Founder: Aman Srivastava and team, BITS Pilani

Area: Assistive tech

About: They developed Annie, the world's first Braille self-learning device for visually impaired children. It's now used in classrooms to make Braille education fun and independent.



THE INDIA INCORPORATION : A MAGNET FOR GLOBAL INVESTMENT

~BY ANSHUL GUPTA





India has become a top destination for foreign direct investment (FDI), thanks to its stable economic policies, digital reforms, and a large consumer base.

Government initiatives like Make in India and Atmanirbhar Bharat have created a favourable environment for global investors and manufacturing giants.

Strategic Advantage:

India's membership in trade groups like BRICS and its growing ties with countries in Europe, Southeast Asia, and Africa are increasing its influence in global economic affairs.

- **Startups and Innovation:**

India's startup ecosystem is booming, with over 100 unicorns and a growing focus on deep tech, fintech, edtech, and green tech. Innovation hubs, accelerators, and government support are fuelling a new wave of entrepreneurship

- **Challenges and the Road Ahead:**

While India's progress is impressive, there are challenges to overcome—such as improving ease of doing business, enhancing infrastructure, and addressing income inequality.



India's Market Meltdown: A Wake-Up Call for Global Investors:

Key Factors Behind the Crash:-

1. Global Trade Tensions:

The U.S. administration's imposition of sweeping tariffs on imports from countries including China, Canada, and Mexico disrupted global trade dynamics.

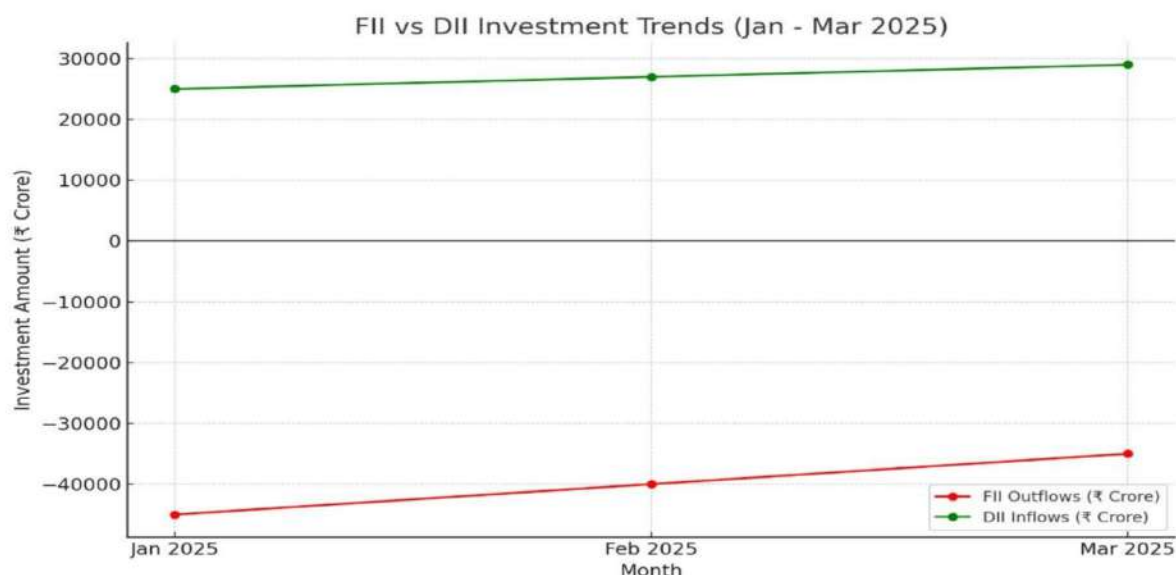
2. Foreign Investor Exodus:

Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) withdrew over ₹1.13 lakh crore from Indian equities in 2025.

3. Domestic Economic Concerns:

Anticipation of slowing GDP growth and weakening corporate earnings added to investor anxiety, leading to a sell-off in key sectors such as banking and IT.





Here's a graph comparing FII outflows and DII inflows in India during the stock market crash of early 2025.

Here's a graph comparing FII outflows and DII inflows in India during the stock market crash of early 2025.

This graph shows the monthly trend of FII outflows and DII inflows during the market crash from January to March 2025:

- FIIs (Foreign Institutional Investors) Consistently pulled out large amounts of capital, with outflows decreasing from ₹45,000 crore in January to ₹30,000 crores in March.
- DIIs (Domestic Institutional Investors) continued to invest steadily, slightly increasing their inflows each month.

Key Insight: While foreign investors exited due to global uncertainties, domestic investors helped cushion the impact, showing growing confidence in India's long-term prospects.

The Rise of Green Capital: Is Sustainability the New Currency of Business?

What is Green Capital?

Green capital refers to financial investments made in businesses or technologies that prioritize environmental sustainability - think renewable energy, electric vehicles, and carbon-neutral operations.





ESG: The Game-Changer

Environmental, Social, and Governance (ESG) metrics are becoming central to investor decisions. In India, ESG funds grew by over 70% in just two years, showing how investors are rewarding responsible businesses.

Indian Companies Leading the Way:

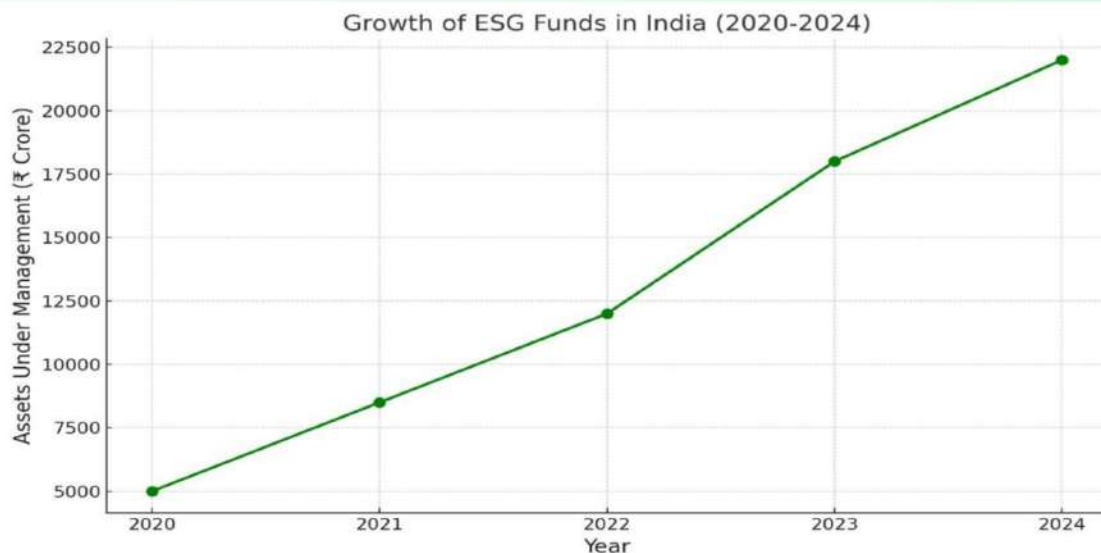
- Tata Power is pushing solar energy initiatives.
- Infosys has achieved carbon neutrality.
- Zomato and Swiggy are experimenting with electric delivery fleets.

Green Startups on the Rise:

- BluSmart (EV ride-hailing)
- Beco (eco-friendly home products)
- Log9 Materials (clean energy tech)

The Future is Green

India's G20 presidency in 2023 emphasized green development. With government incentives and public awareness growing, businesses that embrace sustainability early are likely to lead tomorrow's economy.



Here's an infographic showing the steady rise of ESG (Sustainable Investment) fund in India from 2020 to 2024.





MR. BATUK SHARMA

Batuk Sharma is a dynamic tech entrepreneur and community leader based in Indore, India. He is the founder and CEO of Alertcode and Life Essentials, ventures that focus on delivering innovative tech solutions and fostering personal growth. Batuk Sir generously gave us his time for this insightful conversation.

BUILDING BEYOND CODE: MR. BATUK SHARMA ON STARTUPS, SELF-BELIEF & STAYING AHEAD OF THE CURVE

INTERVIEWED BY AAFREEN KHAN

1. To begin with, could you tell us how your journey into tech and entrepreneurship began?

Honestly, it wasn't a planned journey. I never set out thinking I'd be an entrepreneur. It started from a place of wanting to add value to others. We began the Acropolis Blockchain Club to genuinely help our juniors — no psycho fancy, just real guidance. Then came Life Essentials, a blog aimed at inspiring people on a larger scale. That led to Alert Code, a tech startup. We now work with clients from Dubai, the UK, the US, and Australia — and soon, we'll be launching our own brands and products too.

2. You're managing multiple ventures. What would you say is the most rewarding part of it all?

The rewards do come, but the struggles in the initial stages far outweigh them. We bootstrapped everything — from savings, freelancing, and even speaking sessions. But what really makes it worth it is the impact. When people message saying they started their journey in Web3 or tech because of our work, that's the real reward. Our goal with Life Essentials and Alert Code has always been to provide value, not just chase money.

3. What roadmap would you suggest for beginners who want to enter the tech world?

Have a clear vision. Don't just randomly dive in. Choose a field — be it AI, full stack, or Web3 — and go deep. Most colleges still run on outdated curricula and don't prepare you for evolving tech landscapes. So, do something different. Create an impact, stand out. Join clubs, but do your research — club politics are real, and they can either elevate or hold you back.

4. Speaking of evolving tech — which technologies do you believe hold the most promise for the future?

AI, Web3, and full stack development are the key players. Especially **Web3 — it's poised to grow tremendously in the next four to five years.** I've seen how clubs can open doors, so I always encourage students to join the right ones and push the bar. That's how we tackled the politics and raised the level of what our club did.

5. How do you balance your personal life and friendships with your academic and professional responsibilities?

I keep my circle tight — fewer friends, more meaningful connections. That helps with focus. Connections are strategic — they push you forward. Friends, while important, can sometimes distract if not chosen wisely. The biggest eye-opener? Realizing who genuinely supports you. Jealousy and insecurity are real, even from people close to you. But I learned something important — **buses have more seats than cars for a reason.** Not everyone is meant to travel with you long term. Time management and a strong support system are key.

6. How do you compare India's startup ecosystem with that of China or Dubai?

Dubai is catching up fast — I actually believe it'll surpass China in terms of startups. The registration processes are smoother, and there are fewer restrictions. India has great potential, but we need massive government support and infrastructure investment. The historical impact of British rule still echoes in how slowly we've progressed compared to others.

7. What would you say are the essential skills every young person should develop?

Four big ones — communication, sales, financial literacy, and observation. Communication isn't just for interviews; it's for life. Sales skills help you sell yourself, your ideas, your vision. Financial literacy teaches you how to sustain success. And **observation helps you navigate the world** — it's underrated but critical.

8. Before we wrap up — what advice would you leave our readers with?

Trust yourself. Believe in God. Keep showing up. Don't underestimate the power of consistent effort. And be kind — I once helped a colleague who later played a major role in a turning point of my career. That's the beauty of giving without expecting.

HOLDING ON, ONE STEP AT A TIME: DR. SHRADDHA TIWARI ON MENTAL HEALTH & MEANING

DR. SHRADDHA TIWARI

INTERVIEWED BY AAFREEN KHAN

With a rising tide of anxiety, apathy, and hopelessness, especially among the youth, we turned to psychologist Dr. Shraddha Tiwari for insight. In this deeply honest conversation, she sheds light on apathy, suicidal ideation, and how we can slowly rediscover a sense of meaning.



What does it mean to lose the will to live?

"It often starts with hopelessness," Dr. Tiwari says. "There's a drop in self-esteem, a sense of helplessness, and an emotional shutdown that can spiral into suicidal thoughts."

Why are these issues so common today?

Social media and unstable support systems play a role. "Even small setbacks now feel magnified. Unrealistic expectations and emotional disconnection are affecting young minds more than ever."

Can apathy exist without depression?

"Yes," she confirms. "While apathy is often a symptom of depression, it can also exist independently. To check for depression one thing I always ask people to look out for is emotional responsiveness. Are they withdrawing socially? Are they indifferent toward things that once mattered? These are early warning signs, and if caught early, we can intervene more effectively."

How can someone rediscover meaning?

"Start small," she advises. "Connection is key. Talk to people. It doesn't have to be deep — even light conversations can help you feel seen. Take up journaling, reading, or any hobby that gives you a sense of identity. Spiritual practices like prayer or meditation also help a lot of people. But above all, consistency is key. Healing doesn't happen overnight — it builds with repetition. Creative practices and therapy can make a huge difference."

What are her top tips for mental wellness?

"Read. Move your body. Talk to someone. Try art, dance, or just sit in nature. Build tiny habits, and lean into routines that ground you."

What if someone feels completely hopeless or has suicidal thoughts?

"Please reach out," she urges. "First, I want them to know — you're not alone, and you're not broken. Feeling anxious or lost is part of being human, but don't isolate yourself. The first step is to tell someone. Never go through this alone. I also encourage building self-love and resilience through small, daily acts. And be kind to yourself in the process. Self-love and seeking help go hand-in-hand."

FINAL MESSAGE?

"Take life one day at a time. Ask for help. Keep showing up. Be patient, stay open, and don't give up on yourself."



The Machines We Dream Of: 2025's Hottest Cars and Automotive Marvels

Car enthusiasts don't just love vehicles. They live for the sound, the shape, the engineering, and the feeling of connection between man and machine.

You know that feeling when you see a car that makes your heart skip? This list is full of those. These are the machines built to be stared at, heard, and driven hard.



Ferrari 12Cilindri: A V12 Love Letter
Ferrari isn't letting go of its soul just yet. The new 12Cilindri is a front-engine V12 masterpiece that feels like a tribute to the golden age of Maranello. With 819 hp and styling inspired by the Daytona, it's pure art on wheels, naturally aspirated, unapologetically loud, and gloriously Italian.



Lamborghini Revuelto: Electrified Fury

The Revuelto marks a historic shift, it's Lambo's first plug-in hybrid V12, combining 1,001 hp from a new 6.5L engine and three electric motors. It's still all drama, all aggression, all Lamborghini. But with 21st-century firepower.

Porsche 911 ST: Heritage Reimagined

Porsche brought the past into the future with the limited-run 911 ST. Think: 518 hp, a 4.0L flat-six from the GT3 RS, and a six-speed manual. Lightweight, beautifully analog, and destined to be a collector's gem.





Koenigsegg Jesko Absolut: The Pursuit of 300+ MPH

If physics had a poster child, it would be the Jesko Absolut. Koenigsegg designed it to be the fastest car ever made, aiming to break the 300 mph barrier with stunning aero and a 1,600 hp twin-turbo V8. It's not just a car, it's a scientific experiment with carbon fiber wings.

Rimac Nevera: The Electric Thunderstorm

0 to 60 in 1.74 seconds. That's not a typo. The Rimac Nevera is an all-electric hypercar that's redefining performance. Four motors, 1,914 hp, and more computing power than a spaceship. And it doesn't even make a sound. Goosebumps, minus the growl.



Aston Martin Valour: Manual Madness

To celebrate its 110th anniversary, Aston Martin dropped the Valour, a retro-styled coupe with a twin-turbo V12 and a manual gearbox. Only 110 units exist, each one a delicious contradiction of old-school soul and modern muscle.

BMW's Color-Changing E-Ink Paint

BMW's i Vision Dee concept showed off e-ink paint that changes colors with a tap. Yes, like a real-life mood ring on four wheels. It's still in the prototype phase, but imagine your car matching your outfit or your mood.



Hyundai N Vision 74: Cyberpunk, But Real

Forget everything you know about Hyundai. The N Vision 74 is a hydrogen-powered, rear-wheel drive homage to the Pony Coupe—but it looks like it belongs in a sci-fi film. 671 hp, drift-happy tuning, and an attitude that screams concept-car-turned-dream-come-true.

The cars of 2025 are more than machines. They're statements. Some bring back the thrill of analog. Others leap ahead with electrified ambition or futuristic tech. But all of them do one thing, they make us feel.

Whether you're driving one or just drooling over the photos, one thing is clear, these cars aren't just machines. They're the stuff of dreams.

CLOSET *chronicles*

~ By Ananya Panwar

so pretty



Basics you need

CASUAL *Style*



WORK *Style*



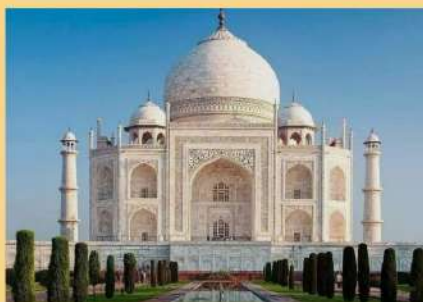
SPRING *Style*





Desi Trivia

~By Ali Aamir



1. The Taj Mahal is Not a Palace...

Thought by many to be a palace, the iconic Taj Mahal, one of the new 7 Wonders of the World, is in fact a mausoleum. Commissioned by the Mughal Emperor Shah Jahan in memory of his beloved wife, the Taj Mahal was constructed between 1632 and 1653. The architectural masterpiece is renowned for its symmetrical beauty and exquisite craftsmanship and was designated a UNESCO World Heritage Site in 1983.



2. The Game of Chess originated in India:

The game of chess originated in ancient India. Around the 6th century AD, the earliest form of the game, known as Chaturanga, was developed.



3. India is the Largest Producer of Films in the World

A lesser-known fact about India is that it is the world's largest film producer and boasts the second-oldest film industry globally. With an extensive domestic following and a substantial international audience, the impact of Indian cinema is significant and far-reaching. At the forefront of this cinematic landscape is Bollywood in Mumbai



5. Anti-Gravity hill in India: Anti-Gravity Hill?

The Magnetic Hill in Ladakh, India, is an intriguing natural wonder that seemingly defies the laws of gravity. Located on the Leh-Kargil-Baltic National Highway, this hill creates an optical illusion making it appear as though vehicles are rolling uphill against gravity when they are actually moving downhill.



6. India is Home to Some of the World's Oldest Continuously Inhabited Cities

The oldest of India's continuously inhabited cities is its spiritual capital of Varanasi, located along the banks of the sacred Ganges River. Incredibly, this North Indian city has a 3000+ year history dating back to at least 1200 BCE.



7. The Kumbh Mela is the world's largest religious gathering

Held every 12 years, the Kumbh Mela attracts millions of pilgrims to bathe in sacred rivers. The event is considered the largest peaceful gathering of people in the world.



8. Snakes and Ladders is Indian:

Yes, Snakes and Ladders. That old board game that's especially fun to bust out on a rainy day. It originates in India, with some historians thinking it may date from as long ago as the 13th century BCE. That makes Snakes and Ladders 15,000 years old!



9. India is the Spice Powerhouse of the World

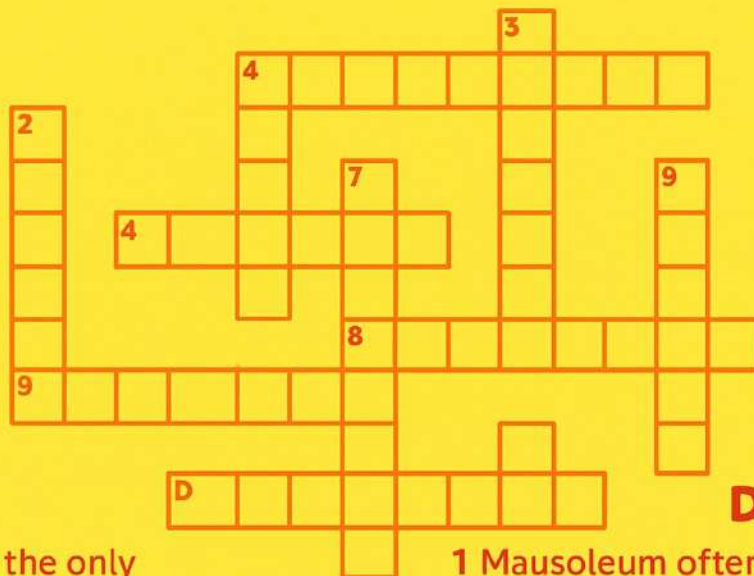
India produces 75 out of 109 recognized spice varieties, making it the global leader in spice production. Fresh spice adds the punch for which Indian food is known and loved.



10. Floating post office? India's got one

India is home to the only floating post office in the world! Located on Dal Lake in Kashmir, this post office sits on a houseboat.

DESI TRIVIA CROSSWORD



ACROSS

- 2 City home to the only floating post office
- 4 Ancient Indian game that inspired a modern board game
- 5 City considered India's spiritual capital
- 7 Illusion who built the Taj Mahal

DOWN

- 1 Mausoleum often mistaken for a palace
- 3 Ancient name for chess
- 6 Largest religious gathering in the world
- 10 India is the top global producer

THE CURATOR

2025

VOICES THAT MATTER

